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HOW TO CHOOSE SKI AREA MANAGEMENT SOFTWARE

A buyer's guide for independent ski areas: when to switch, what to compare, and the questions to ask every vendor before you sign.

WHAT TO COMPARE

FIT FOR A SMALL OPERATION

- Can you turn on only the parts you run, and pay only for those?
- Does it run on the computers, tablets and phones you already have?
- Can a seasonal crew learn it in a morning?

SAFETY RECORDS

- Are patrol, lift and park records kept intact, with who changed what and when?
- Can a lift or feature that failed inspection be kept from being marked open?
- Does patrol keep working when a phone loses signal on the hill?

MONEY

- Where do guest card payments go: into your own processor account, or through the vendor?
- What does each card payment cost, all fees included?
- Can the counter take cards on a reader that the software charges directly, so nobody types amounts twice?

YOUR DATA

- Can you export everything, at any time, without asking?
- What happens to your data if you leave?
- Can they import your customers, pass holders and products from your current system?

SUPPORT

- Who answers at 8 a.m. on a holiday Saturday, and how fast?
- What counts as urgent, in writing?
- How often do they release changes, and never on which days?

QUESTIONS TO ASK EVERY VENDOR

Print this and take it to every demo. The same questions for each vendor make the answers comparable.

- ☐ **What does it cost** in total for our mountain for a year, including setup, hardware, card fees and support?
- ☐ **Is there a contract**, how long, and how do we leave?
- ☐ **Where do our guests' card payments go**, and when do we get the money?
- ☐ **Can we start with one part** and add others later?
- ☐ **Can we see it with our own data**, or a demo mountain like ours, not a slideshow?

- [ ] **How do you import** our customers, pass holders and products?
- [ ] **What hardware do we need**, and does our current hardware work?
- [ ] **What happens when the internet drops** at the counter or on the hill?
- [ ] **How are patrol and inspection records protected** from being changed or deleted?
- [ ] **Can we export all our data** ourselves, any time?
- [ ] **Who answers on a peak Saturday morning**, and how fast?
- [ ] **Can we talk to your support team and to your founding mountains?**

The full guide, with common questions: www.runmyresort.com/how-to-choose-ski-area-software. Have your insurer and attorney review any procedure before you adopt it.